Romina Mahinpei

rmahinpei@princeton.edu rmahinpei.github.io rmahinpei rmahinpei

EDUCATION

PhD in Computer Science **07/2026 – Present**
Princeton University
- **Advisors**: Prof. Manoel Horta Ribeiro & Prof. Andrés Monroy-Hernández
- **Research Areas**: Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (HAI), Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Computational Social Science (CSS), Social Computing.
- **Research Methods**: Mixed-methods, semi-structured interviews, surveys, randomized field experiments, behavioral data analysis, human-centered system design and evaluation.

MSE in Computer Science **08/2024 – 05/2026**
Princeton University GPA: 4.0 / 4.0
- **Advisor**: Prof. Manoel Horta Ribeiro

B.Sc. in Honours Computer Science with a Mathematics Minor **09/2020 – 04/2024**
The University of British Columbia (UBC) GPA: 4.0 / 4.0

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscripts

1. **Romina Mahinpei**, Manoel Horta Ribeiro, Andrés Monroy-Hernández, Sohyeon Hwang. 2026. *"Okay, I've Actually Softened My Take on This": How People in Decentralized Social Media Reason about the Appropriateness of Generative AI.* [Preprint]. Under Review.

2. **Romina Mahinpei**, Victoria Dean, Ruth Fong, Lydia T. Liu, Manoel Horta Ribeiro. 2026. *AI Assistance for Discretionary Work: Increasing Feedback Provision in Higher Education.* [Preprint]. Under Review.

Conference Papers

1. Irix Xu*, **Romina Mahinpei***, Steven Wolfman, and Firas Moosvi. 2026. *Performance and Start-Time Trends in Asynchronous Computer-Based Assessments*. [Paper]. In Proceedings of the 57th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education, Volume 2 **(SIGCSE TS 2026)**.

2. **Romina Mahinpei**, Manoel Horta Ribeiro, Mae Milano. 2025. *Interactive Theorem Provers for Proof Education*. [Paper]. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM SIGPLAN International Symposium on SPLASH-E **(SPLASH-E '25)**.

3. Ivan Orozco Vasquez*, **Romina Mahinpei***, Noureddine Elouazizi, Cristina Conati. 2025. *An Emergent Bottom-Up Categorization of Students' LLMs Usage in an Undergraduate Research Course*. [Paper]. Artificial Intelligence in Education **(AIED 2025)**. Lecture Notes in Computer Science, Volume 15881.

4. **Romina Mahinpei***, Iris Xu*, Steven Wolfman, and Firas Moosvi. 2025. *A Generalized Framework for Describing Question Randomization*. [Paper]. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on International Computing Education, Volume 1 **(ICER 2025)**.

Posters & Workshops

1. **Romina Mahinpei**, Diya Ajay Hundiwala, Sandy Zhang, Lana Glisic, Andrés Monroy-Hernández. *How Children Collaborate within Programmable AR Environments with Co-Located Collaborative Features*. [Poster]. Proceedings of the 2026 Companion of the Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing **(CSCW 2026)**.

2. **Romina Mahinpei**, Victoria Dean, Ruth Fong, Manoel Horta Ribeiro. *AI Assistance for Discretionary Work: Increasing Feedback Provision in Higher Education*. [Non-Archival Presentation]. 12th International Conference on Computational Social Science **(IC2S2 2026)**.

3. **Romina Mahinpei**, Sofiia Druchyna, Xinran Bi. 2026. *CNPE: A Framework for Challenges and Needs in Proof Education*. [Poster]. In Proceedings of the 57th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education, Volume 2 **(SIGCSE TS 2026)**.

4. Anha Khan, **Romina Mahinpei**, Maryam Hedayati, Victoria Dean and Ruth Fong. 2026. *Characterizing the Relationship Between Generative AI, Student Behavior, and Learning Outcomes in Upper-Level CS Education: A Case Study in an Undergraduate Machine Learning Course*. [Poster]. In Proceedings of the 57th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education, Volume 2 **(SIGCSE TS 2026)**.

5. Adam Craig Pocock, Joseph Wonsil, **Romina Mahinpei**, Jack Sullivan, Margo Seltzer. 2025. *Provenance Design and Evolution in a Production ML Library*. [Workshop Poster]. Championing Open-source DEvelopment in ML Workshop @ ICML25 (**CODEML @ICML 2025**).

6. **Romina Mahinpei***, Iris Xu*, Steven Wolfman, and Firas Moosvi. 2024. *A Generalized Framework for Describing Question Randomization*. [Poster]. In Proceedings of the 55th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education, Volume 2 **(SIGCSE TS 2024)**.

AWARDS

Canada Graduate Research Scholarship – Doctoral Program | NSERC **2026**
- Awarded in recognition of outstanding academic achievement, research excellence, and doctoral potential.

McGraw Center for Teaching & Learning Fellowship | Princeton University **2024**
- Awarded for the 2024-2025 academic year to support the research, design, and development of Princeton University's STEM pedagogical resources.

Canada Graduate Research Scholarship – Master's Program | NSERC **2024**
- *[Declined]* Awarded in recognition of outstanding academic achievement and research potential.

Academic Award of Excellence | Department of Computer Science, UBC **2024**
- Awarded to the student with the highest graduating average of the B.Sc. in Honours Computer Science.

Markus Meister Memorial Prize | Department of Computer Science, UBC **2024**
- Awarded to the graduating student with the highest standing in the final year of the B.Sc. in Computer Science.

Trek Excellence Scholarship for Continuing Students | UBC **2021–2023**
- Awarded yearly to domestic undergraduate students in the top 5% of their year, faculty, and school.

Schulich Leader Scholarship | The Schulich Foundation **2020**
- Selected as one of 100 Canadian high school seniors nationwide to receive a four-year, full-tuition STEM scholarship recognizing academic excellence, leadership potential, and community involvement.

Governor General's Academic Medal | The Governor General of Canada **2020**
- Awarded to the graduating student with the highest academic standing at Carson Graham Secondary School.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Humans & Machines Lab | Prof. Manoel Horta Ribeiro | Princeton University **01/2025 – Present**
- Studying human-centered AI and computational social science in online platforms and communities.

Princeton HCI Lab | Prof. Andrés Monroy-Hernández | Princeton University **09/2024 – Present**
- Studying human-centered AI and social computing in online platforms and communities.

Human-AI Interaction Lab | Prof. Cristina Conati | UBC **01/2024 – 08/2025**
- Studied students' use of generative AI and adaptive educational systems.

Scientific Computing Lab | Prof. Chen Greif | UBC **05/2023 – 05/2024**
- Studied high performance computing and mixed-precision iterative methods for large-scale linear systems.

Systopia Lab | Prof. Margo Seltzer | UBC **01/2022 – 01/2023**
- Studied data provenance and developed the Model Card feature for Oracle's Tribuo ML library.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant | Empirical Research Methods in CS | Princeton University **01/2026 – 04/2026**

Head Teaching Assistant | Introductory Machine Learning | Princeton University **01/2025 – 01/2026**

Teaching Assistant | Introductory Machine Learning | Princeton University **08/2024 – 01/2025**

Head Teaching Assistant | Operating Systems | UBC **09/2023 – 04/2024**

Teaching Assistant | Software Engineering | UBC **09/2022 – 04/2023**

Teaching Assistant | Differential & Integral Calculus | UBC **09/2021 – 04/2022**

MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Yusuf Abdelnur | Undergraduate CS Student | Princeton University **2026-2027**
- Graduate mentor for senior thesis.

Om Vyas | Undergraduate CS Student | Princeton University **2026-2027**
- Graduate mentor for senior thesis.

Anha Khan | Undergraduate CS Student | Princeton University **2025-2026**
- Graduate mentor for senior thesis.
- Co-winner of **Princeton's Outstanding Computer Science Senior Thesis Prize (2026)**.
- First Place in **ACM Student Research Competition Grand Finals (2026)**.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern (Xbox AI) | Microsoft **06/2025 – 08/2025**
- Built a context-aware extension for Visual Studio's Copilot for internal developers.

Software Engineering Intern (Xbox Experimentation) | Microsoft **06/2024 – 08/2024**
- Developed Semantic Kernel plugins and evaluation dashboards.

Software Engineering Intern (Xbox Data) | Microsoft **06/2023 – 08/2023**
- Developed monitoring pipelines, availability metrics, and Power BI dashboards for core Xbox data streams.

Software Engineering Intern (Xbox Services) | Microsoft **06/2022 – 08/2022**
- Designed and implemented a personalization feature to enhance Xbox users' gaming experiences.